The History Department

YEAR 8 SCHEME OF WORK (2026-2027)

Curriculum Planning & Lesson Companion

Key Stage 3 Curriculum Intent & Pedagogical Architecture

1. Curriculum Rationale & Local Maritime Heritage

Our Key Stage 3 history curriculum is intentionally constructed to link national and global historical narratives with the distinctive maritime geography and lived environment of The History Portal pupils. From the industrial revolution of the Fareham ironmaster (Henry Cort at Funtley) to the strategic supremacy of Portsmouth Royal Dockyard and the profound sacrifices recorded on the Stubbington village war memorials, history is made tangible, relevant, and deeply rooted in our coastal community.

2. Disciplinary Progression & Historical Enquiry

Across Years 7, 8, and 9, disciplinary thinking progresses sequentially to secure the foundational skills required for GCSE excellence:

- **Chronological Rigour & Global Encounters:** De-centering traditional anglocentric narratives by examining early global trade, Indigenous perspectives in Australia, and African resistance to the Transatlantic Slave Trade alongside British social transformations.
- **Causation & Consequence:** Moving from simple direct triggers in Year 7 to evaluating multi-tiered, long-term geopolitical catalysts (e.g. European alliance systems, naval arms races).
- **Source Utility & Forensic Evidence:** Progressing from basic comprehension to rigorous interrogation of provenance, evaluating authorial motive, audience, and historical reliability.
- **Historiographical Debate:** Engaging pupils with active academic debates (e.g., assessing the Magna Carta, or challenging the 'Lions led by Donkeys' narrative of the Great War) grounded in historical evidence.

3. Adaptive Teaching, Dual Coding & Inclusion

Pupils work through bespoke printed A4 workbooks closely paired with our digital learning portal. Standardized PEE/PEEL Structure Strips, Causal Connective Banks, consistent dual coding, and digital accessibility features offload working memory, ensuring all SEND and lower-attaining pupils achieve ambitious historical progress with zero cognitive overload.

KS3: Early Modern World & Global Encounters (1450–1750)

Year 8 | How 'global' was Britain's transformation between 1450 and 1750?

🌀 **SPIRAL CURRICULUM THEMATIC STRANDS (VERTICAL DISCIPLINARY PROGRESSION)** CHRISTINE COUNSELL CURRICULAR THREADS

SOVEREIGNTY & POWER	EXPLORATION & TRADE	RELIGIOUS VOLATILITY	ENSLAVED RESISTANCE
Divine Right Absolutism → Civil War, Regicide & 1689 Settlement (L4–L6)	Ottoman fall → Tordesillas → East India Co & Mughal trade (L1–L3)	Reformation zeal → Gunpowder Plot & Jacobean Puritan state (L2, L4, L5)	Triangular Trade → The Brookes → Jamaican Maroons & Nanny (L7, L8)

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives & Enquiry	Curriculum Rigour: Evidence, Debate & Assessment
Lesson 1 **Who held global power in 1450?** 🎯 HISTORICAL ENQUIRY - ANALYZING THE MOTIVATIONS BEHIND EARLY GLOBAL EXPLORATION.	• Identify the major global powers and trading hubs in the year 1450. • Explain how the Ottoman Empire and West African kingdoms controlled global wealth. • Evaluate why Western Europe was on the periphery (edges) of world trade in 1450. *Hinge Q: Which empire controlled the vital overland trade route to Asia in 1450?*	📜 **PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS:** Detail from the Catalan Atlas (1375) showing Marco Polo's caravan on the Silk Road; Fresco of the Siege of Constantinople (1537); 16th-Century Benin Bronze Plaque ⚖️ **DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS:** Evaluate why Western Europe was on the periphery (edges) of world trade in 1450. ✍️ **CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT:** **Explain why Europe was not the center of global wealth and power in 1450.**

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives & Enquiry	Curriculum Rigour: Evidence, Debate & Assessment
Lesson 2 **How did religious conflict trigger global exploration (1517–1588)?** 🎯 CHANGE AND CONTINUITY - EXAMINING THE IMPACT OF THE PRINTING PRESS ON SOCIETY.	• Explain how the Protestant Reformation shattered European unity after 1517. • Analyze the role of Elizabethan privateers in challenging Catholic Spain's global monopoly. • Evaluate how the Spanish Armada (1588) marked a turning point in Britain's imperial ambitions. ***Hinge Q: How did Martin Luther's actions in 1517 directly contribute to the later naval conflict between England and Spain?***	📜 **PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS:** Portrait of Gerardus Mercator (1574); Portrait of Martin Luther (1529); Map of the Treaty of Tordesillas (1494) ⚖️ **DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS:** Evaluate how the Spanish Armada (1588) marked a turning point in Britain's imperial ambitions. ✍️ **CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT:** **How did the Protestant Reformation push England into global exploration and conflict with Spain?**
Lesson 3 **Trade or takeover: How did early encounters turn into empire?** 🎯 CAUSATION - INVESTIGATING THE CAUSES OF THE REFORMATION.	• Explain how joint-stock corporations (like the East India Company and Virginia Company) funded early English expansion. • Compare the early English colonial encounters in North America (Roanoke and Jamestown) with mercantile trade in Mughal India. • Evaluate the turning point where peaceful commercial trade shifted into territorial takeover and subjugation. ***Hinge Q: Why did the English rely on joint-stock companies rather than royal armies to explore and trade overseas?***	📜 **PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS:** Sir Thomas Roe at the Mughal Court (1615); View of the Thirteen Factories in Canton (c. 1800); Plan of James Fort in Virginia (1607) ⚖️ **DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS:** Evaluate the turning point where peaceful commercial trade shifted into territorial takeover and subjugation. ✍️ **CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT:** **Explain how the creation of the East India Company (EIC) transformed British trade.**
Lesson 4 **James I and the Gunpowder Plot: Why was religious division so volatile?** 🎯 SIGNIFICANCE - EVALUATING THE IMPACT OF THE RENAISSANCE ON ART AND SCIENCE.	• Understand the motivations and consequences of the Gunpowder Plot. ***Hinge Q: What is the most significant consequence of the Gunpowder Plot?***	📜 **PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS:** Contemporary primary excerpts and archival evidence. ⚖️ **DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS:** Core Disciplinary Concept: Significance - Evaluating the impact of the Renaissance on art and science. & Causal Argumentation ✍️ **CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT:** **[Written Task] Newspaper Front Page**
Lesson 5 **Who controlled Britain? The Ideological Battle** 🎯 CAUSATION - ANALYZING THE REASONS FOR THE SPANISH ARMADA'S DEFEAT.	• Analyze why King Charles I and Parliament fought the English Civil War (1642–1651). • Evaluate how colonial wealth from sugar and tobacco reshaped British politics during the Commonwealth. • Debate who held true power in Britain by 1660: the Monarchy, Parliament, or Atlantic Capitalists. ***Hinge Q: What was the 'Divine Right of Kings', and how did it lead Charles I into direct conflict with Parliament?***	📜 **PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS:** The East Offering its Riches to Britannia (1778) ⚖️ **DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS:** Evaluate how colonial wealth from sugar and tobacco reshaped British politics during the Commonwealth. ✍️ **CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT:** **How did the English Civil War and the execution of Charles I change the balance of power?**
Lesson 6 **Who controlled Britain? The Economic Shift** 🎯 CHANGE AND CONTINUITY - TRACING THE ECONOMIC SHIFT TOWARDS GLOBAL TRADE.	• Understand the major economic changes of the 17th century. • Analyze the impact of colonial wealth on social structures. ***Hinge Q: How did colonial expansion lead to an economic shift in Europe?***	📜 **PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS:** The East Offering its Riches to Britannia (1778); The Royal Exchange, London (1644); The Great Seal of the Commonwealth of England (1651) ⚖️ **DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS:** Core Disciplinary Concept: Change and Continuity - Tracing the economic shift towards global trade. & Causal Argumentation ✍️ **CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT:** **Explain how the 'Financial Revolution' (like the Bank of England) helped Britain build a modern empire.**

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives & Enquiry	Curriculum Rigour: Evidence, Debate & Assessment
Lesson 7 **What were the mechanics of the Transatlantic Slave Trade?** 🎯 SIGNIFICANCE - UNDERSTANDING THE CONSEQUENCES OF THE ENGLISH CIVIL WAR.	• Understand the Triangular Trade and the middle passage. • Evaluate the economic legacy of slavery on Britain. *Hinge Q: What were the three main 'legs' of the Triangular Trade?*	📜 **PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS:** Contemporary primary excerpts and archival evidence. ⚖️ **DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS:** Evaluate the economic legacy of slavery on Britain. ✍️ **CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT:** **How did the Triangular Trade directly enrich British port cities?**
Lesson 8 **How did enslaved Africans resist the Transatlantic Slave Trade?** 🎯 CAUSATION - WHY DID THE WITCH CRAZE SPREAD ACROSS EARLY MODERN EUROPE?	• Analyze primary sources from formerly enslaved Africans. • Investigate the Jamaican Maroon Wars. *Hinge Q: How does Olaudah Equiano's account challenge the idea that enslaved people were passive?*	📜 **PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS:** Portrait of Olaudah Equiano (1789); Map of the Stono Rebellion route (1739); 18th-century botanical illustration of the Cassava root ⚖️ **DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS:** Core Disciplinary Concept: Causation - Why did the Witch Craze spread across early modern Europe? & Causal Argumentation ✍️ **CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT:** **Explain how the Jamaican Maroons successfully resisted British control.**
Lesson 9 **How 'modern' was Britain by 1750? (Synthesis & Assessment)** 🎯 HISTORICAL ENQUIRY - EVALUATING THE LEGACY OF THE EARLY MODERN ERA.	• Define what historians mean by a 'modern' state in the context of 18th-century Europe. • Synthesise domestic social realities with imperial/commercial expansion across the period 1450–1750. • Construct a high-level, structured final essay evaluating the extent of Britain's 'modernity' by 1750. *Hinge Q: What specific economic and political institutions made Britain look 'modern' by 1750?*	📜 **PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS:** The East Offering its Riches to Britannia (1778); The Royal Exchange, London (1644); John Rocque's Map of London (1746) ⚖️ **DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS:** Construct a high-level, structured final essay evaluating the extent of Britain's 'modernity' by 1750. ✍️ **CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT:** **How 'modern' was Britain by 1750?**

KS3: The Industrial Revolution (1750–1900)

Year 8 | How did steam, factories, and the fight for democracy transform Britain?

🌀 **SPIRAL CURRICULUM THEMATIC STRANDS (VERTICAL DISCIPLINARY PROGRESSION)** CHRISTINE COUNSELL CURRICULAR THREADS

SOVEREIGNTY & POWER
State institutions, governance, authority and constitutional development

TRADE & TECHNOLOGY
Economic engines, technical innovations and overseas geopolitical interactions

IDEOLOGY & CAUSATION
Religious beliefs, philosophical movements and drivers of historical change

RESISTANCE & AGENCY
Popular protest, social struggle, rights development and civilian agency

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives & Enquiry	Curriculum Rigour: Evidence, Debate & Assessment
Lesson 1 **What powered the Industrial Revolution, and how did a Fareham ironmaster change the world?** 🎯 TECHNOLOGICAL INNOVATION & ECONOMIC TRANSFORMATION	• Explain how the transition from the domestic system to coal and Watt's steam engine liberated manufacturing from river valleys. • Analyse how Henry Cort's twin inventions at Funtley (puddling and rolling) solved the Royal Navy's pig iron crisis, and evaluate the surviving physical archaeology at the site. • Evaluate whether Henry Cort's triumph was driven primarily by geographical proximity to Portsmouth Dockyard or technological genius. ***Hinge Q: Why did James Watt's steam engine allow British factories to move from remote rural rivers into crowded industrial cities?*** ⏱ **Delivery Phasing (2-Lesson Enquiry Sequence (2x 50 mins) or 100-min Double Period)** **L1 (Reading & Sources): 00–10m:** Hook & Prior Retrieval • **10–30m:** Modelled Shared Reading • **30–45m:** Archival & Fieldwork Analysis • **45–50m:** Formative Hinge Plenary **L2 (Debate & Writing): 00–10m:** Spaced Retrieval & Vocab Anchor • **10–25m:** Shared Reading & Historiographical Debate • **25–45m:** Workbook Application (Pages 4–5) • **45–50m:** Live Exemplar Debrief	📜 **PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS:** Source A: Coalbrookdale by Night (1801); Coalbrookdale by Night (1801) by Philipp Jakob de Loutherbourg; Source B: Cort's Reverberatory Puddling Furnace (1783) ⚖️ **DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS:** Analyse how Henry Cort's twin inventions at Funtley (puddling and rolling) solved the Royal Navy's pig iron crisis, and evaluate the surviving physical archaeology at the site. ✍️ **CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT:** **[Written Task] Enquiry Essay: "How significant was Henry Cort's puddling process to British industrial and naval supremacy?"**
Lesson 2 **Was industrial work progress or punishment?** 🎯 CHANGE & CONTINUITY IN AGRARIAN SOCIETY	• Explain how the transition from the domestic system to steam-powered factories transformed working life, discipline, and physical danger. • Analyse how Victorian urbanization triggered the Fareham Red Brick Boom and the exploitation of child labour in local Hampshire clay pits. • Evaluate the Optimist vs. Pessimist historical debate regarding whether industrial work represented societal progress or human punishment. ***Hinge Q: Why was working under a steam-powered factory machine radically more dangerous and exhausting than working in a domestic cottage workshop?*** ⏱ **Delivery Phasing (2-Lesson Enquiry Sequence (2x 50 mins) or 100-min Double Period)** **L1 (Reading & Sources): 00–10m:** Hook & Prior Retrieval • **10–30m:** Modelled Shared Reading • **30–45m:** Archival & Local Analysis • **45–50m:** Formative Hinge Plenary **L2 (Debate & Writing): 00–10m:** Spaced Retrieval & Vocab Anchor • **10–25m:** Shared Reading & Historiographical Debate • **25–45m:** Workbook Application (Pages 6–7) • **45–50m:** Live Exemplar Debrief	📜 **PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS:** Source A: Powerloom Weaving in 1835; Thomas Allom, Powerloom Weaving in 1835; Source B: The Royal Albert Hall, London (1871) ⚖️ **DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS:** Evaluate the Optimist vs. Pessimist historical debate regarding whether industrial work represented societal progress or human punishment. ✍️ **CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT:** **[Written Task] Enquiry Essay: "To what extent was industrial work in 19th-century Britain an engine of human punishment rather than societal progress for the working classes?"**

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives & Enquiry	Curriculum Rigour: Evidence, Debate & Assessment
Lesson 3 **Did industrialisation make British towns unlivable?** 🎯 SOURCE UTILITY & WORKING-CLASS CONDITIONS	• Explain how rapid urbanisation, back-to-back housing, and contaminated cesspools created deadly conditions in industrial cities. • Analyse how King Cholera and the 1858 Great Stink shattered the government's laissez-faire ideology. • Evaluate Edwin Chadwick's 1842 Sanitary Report and the 1875 Public Health Act using forensic archival evidence. ***Hinge Q: Why did the lack of municipal planning inevitably turn urban water pumps into vectors for waterborne disease?*** ⏱ **Delivery Phasing (2-Lesson Enquiry Sequence (2x 50 mins) or 100-min Double Period)** **L1 (Reading & Sources): 00–10m:** Hook & Prior Retrieval • **10–30m:** Modelled Shared Reading • **30–45m:** Archival & Forensic Investigation • **45–50m:** Formative Hinge Plenary **L2 (Debate & Writing): 00–10m:** Spaced Retrieval & Vocab Anchor • **10–25m:** Shared Reading & Engineering Analysis • **25–45m:** Workbook Application (Pages 8–9) • **45–50m:** Live Exemplar Debrief	📜 **PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS:** Source A: Gustave Doré, Over London by Rail (1872); Source B: John Leech, A Court for King Cholera (Punch, 1852); Source C: Edwin Chadwick, Report on the Sanitary Condition of the Labouring Population (1842) ⚖️ **DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS:** Evaluate Edwin Chadwick's 1842 Sanitary Report and the 1875 Public Health Act using forensic archival evidence. ✍️ **CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT:** **[Written Task] Enquiry Essay: "To what extent did industrialisation make 19th-century British towns unlivable death traps for the working classes?"**
Lesson 4 **How did ordinary people fight for a voice?** 🎯 CAUSATION & IMPERIAL EXPANSION	• Explain how post-war economic depression and parliamentary disenfranchisement led to the 1819 Peterloo Massacre. • Analyse how agricultural mechanisation sparked rural rebellion in Hampshire through the Captain Swing Riots. • Evaluate the strategic split within Chartism between Moral Force and Physical Force using primary source manifestos. ***Hinge Q: Why did the ruling aristocracy view peaceful working-class gatherings in Manchester as the start of a French-style revolution?*** ⏱ **Delivery Phasing (2-Lesson Enquiry Sequence (2x 50 mins) or 100-min Double Period)** **L1 (Reading & Sources): 00–10m:** Hook & Prior Retrieval • **10–30m:** Modelled Shared Reading • **30–45m:** Local & Archival Investigation • **45–50m:** Formative Hinge Plenary **L2 (Debate & Writing): 00–10m:** Spaced Retrieval & Vocab Anchor • **10–25m:** Shared Reading & Historiographical Debate • **25–45m:** Workbook Application (Pages 14–15) • **45–50m:** Live Exemplar Debrief	📜 **PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS:** Source A: George Cruikshank, The Massacre of Peterloo (1819); Source B: The Threat of Captain Swing (Hampshire, October 1830); Source C: George Loveless, Statement upon Sentencing at Dorchester Assizes (March 1834) ⚖️ **DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS:** Evaluate the strategic split within Chartism between Moral Force and Physical Force using primary source manifestos. ✍️ **CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT:** **[Written Task] Enquiry Essay: "To what extent did working-class popular protests between 1819 and 1848 achieve their goals of securing political and economic rights?"**

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives & Enquiry	Curriculum Rigour: Evidence, Debate & Assessment
Lesson 5 **How did the road to democracy expand?** 🎯 RESISTANCE & LABOR MOVEMENTS	• Explain the corrupt mechanics of the unreformed electoral system, including Rotten Boroughs and Pocket Boroughs. • Analyse how the fear of violent revolution and middle-class economic pressure forced Parliament to pass the 1832 Great Reform Act. • Evaluate the transformative impact of the 1872 Secret Ballot Act and franchise expansions (1867 & 1884) on working-class political power. ***Hinge Q: Why did the unreformed parliamentary system favor rural southern aristocracy over northern industrial cities?*** ⏱️ **Delivery Phasing (2-Lesson Enquiry Sequence (2x 50 mins) or 100-min Double Period)** **L1 (Reading & Sources): 00–10m:** Hook & Prior Retrieval • **10–30m:** Modelled Shared Reading • **30–45m:** Archival & Strategic Analysis • **45–50m:** Formative Hinge Plenary **L2 (Debate & Writing): 00–10m:** Spaced Retrieval & Vocab Anchor • **10–25m:** Shared Reading & Historiographical Debate • **25–45m:** Workbook Application (Pages 16–17) • **45–50m:** Live Exemplar Debrief	📜 **PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS:** Source A: Parliamentary Representation Map of England & Wales & Unreformed Boroughs (1832); Source B: The School of Reform (Satirical Lithograph on the 1832 Reform Bill); Source C: Minutes of Evidence taken before the Select Committee on Corrupt Practices (1869) ⚖️ **DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS:** Evaluate the transformative impact of the 1872 Secret Ballot Act and franchise expansions (1867 & 1884) on working-class political power. ✍️ **CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT:** **[Written Task] Enquiry Essay: "To what extent was the expansion of British democracy between 1832 and 1884 granted as a tactical concession by ruling elites rather than won by popular wor...**

Unit Key Vocabulary: Industrial Revolution • Industrialisation • Domestic System • Factory System • Puddling Process • Wrought Iron • Steam Power • Urbanisation • Slum • Back-to-Back Housing • Public Health • Cholera • Miasma Theory • Laissez-faire • Child Labour • Factory Acts • Trade Union • Captain Swing • Swing Riots • Chartism • People's Charter • Universal Suffrage • Franchise • Rotten Borough • Pocket Borough • Great Reform Act (1832) • Secret Ballot Act (1872) • Empire • Colonialism • Imperialism • East India Company • Sepoy • Indian Rebellion (1857) • British Raj • Ironclad • Two-Power Standard • Historiography • Optimist View • Pessimist View • Synthesis

KS3: History of Australia

Year 8 | Invasion, Settlement, or Survival? How should we remember the colonization of Australia?

🌀 **SPIRAL CURRICULUM THEMATIC STRANDS (VERTICAL DISCIPLINARY PROGRESSION)** CHRISTINE COUNSELL CURRICULAR THREADS

SOVEREIGNTY & POWER
State institutions, governance, authority and constitutional development

TRADE & TECHNOLOGY
Economic engines, technical innovations and overseas geopolitical interactions

IDEOLOGY & CAUSATION
Religious beliefs, philosophical movements and drivers of historical change

RESISTANCE & AGENCY
Popular protest, social struggle, rights development and civilian agency

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives & Enquiry	Curriculum Rigour: Evidence, Debate & Assessment
Lesson 1 **Claiming Australia** 🎯 HISTORICAL ENQUIRY & ANALYSIS	• Explain the dual purpose of James Cook's voyage, contrasting the public scientific mission with the secret government orders to claim territory. • Analyse the indispensable navigational and diplomatic contributions of the Polynesian high priest and master star navigator, Tupaia. • Evaluate the first encounter at Botany Bay in 1770 from both the British perspective and the defensive spiritual perspective of the Gweagal people. *Hinge Q: How does discovering that Captain Cook carried secret instructions change our understanding of his voyage from a purely scientific mission to an imperial one?*	📜 **PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS:** Source A: Secret Instructions to Captain Cook; Source B: A Portrait of Captain James Cook; Source C: Initial Encounter at Botany Bay ⚖️ **DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS:** Explain the dual purpose of James Cook's voyage, contrasting the public scientific mission with the secret government orders to claim territory. ✍️ **CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT:** **[Written Synthesis] Complete structured analytical enquiry response in pupil workbook.**
Lesson 2 **Creating a Convict Colony** 🎯 HISTORICAL ENQUIRY & ANALYSIS	• Explain how the loss of the American colonies in 1776 directly caused a prison crisis in Britain that led to the system of transportation. • Describe the physical and environmental challenges faced by Captain Arthur Phillip and the convicts during their first year at Sydney Cove. • Analyse the work and social conditions of the convicts, contrasting general labor with the punishments of the chain road gangs. *Hinge Q: How did a political war fought in America in 1776 directly decide the fate of a petty thief in London ten years later?*	📜 **PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS:** Prison Hulks in Portsmouth Harbour ⚖️ **DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS:** Analyse the work and social conditions of the convicts, contrasting general labor with the punishments of the chain road gangs. ✍️ **CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT:** **[Written Synthesis] Complete structured analytical enquiry response in pupil workbook.**
Lesson 3 **Encounters with the Indigenous Peoples** 🎯 HISTORICAL ENQUIRY & ANALYSIS	• Understand the impact of European diseases on the Aboriginal population. • Analyze the resistance of Aboriginal leaders like Pemulwuy. • Examine the Myall Creek Massacre as an example of frontier violence. *Hinge Q: Why were European diseases like smallpox so deadly to the Aboriginal populations?*	📜 **PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS:** Bennelong's Letter to England; Early Settlement at Sydney Cove ⚖️ **DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS:** Core Disciplinary Concept: Historical Enquiry & Causal Argumentation ✍️ **CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT:** **[Written Synthesis] Complete structured analytical enquiry response in pupil workbook.**
Lesson 4 **From Penal Colony to Settlement** 🎯 HISTORICAL ENQUIRY & ANALYSIS	• Explain the role of the wool industry in making the colony economically viable. • Analyze the impact of the 1850s gold rushes on Australian society. • Examine the experiences and treatment of Chinese gold miners. *Hinge Q: Why was the wool industry critical to Australia's early economic survival?*	📜 **PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS:** William Barak's Testimony; The Australian Gold Rush ⚖️ **DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS:** Core Disciplinary Concept: Historical Enquiry & Causal Argumentation ✍️ **CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT:** **[Written Synthesis] Complete structured analytical enquiry response in pupil workbook.**
Lesson 5 **Lesson 5: Assessment - What's the story of Australia?** 🎯 HISTORICAL ENQUIRY & ANALYSIS	• Synthesize knowledge of the development of New South Wales from a penal colony to a profitable settlement. • Evaluate the usefulness of primary sources for historical enquiries. *Hinge Q: Can you sequence the key turning points in the colony's development?*	📜 **PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS:** Contemporary primary excerpts and archival evidence. ⚖️ **DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS:** Evaluate the usefulness of primary sources for historical enquiries. ✍️ **CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT:** **[Written Task] Write a narrative account analyzing the development of Australia between the years 1788 and 1855.**

Unit Key Vocabulary: Ancestors • Botany Bay • Colony • Gweagal • Navigator • Royal Society • Terra Nullius • First Fleet • Convict • Governor • Hard labour • Hulk • Transportation • Sydney Cove • Eora • Frontier • Guerrilla Warfare • Dispossession • Massacre • Squatter • Merino • Gold Rush • Immigrant • Xenophobia • White Australia Policy

Crown, Church, or Parliament (1517–1689)

Year 8 | Who had the right to rule Britain: King, Church, or Parliament?

SPIRAL CURRICULUM THEMATIC STRANDS (VERTICAL DISCIPLINARY PROGRESSION) CHRISTINE COUNSELL CURRICULAR THREADS

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Economic engines, technical innovations and overseas geopolitical interactions

IDEOLOGY & CAUSATION
Religious beliefs, philosophical movements and drivers of historical change

RESISTANCE & AGENCY
Popular protest, social struggle, rights development and civilian agency

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives & Enquiry	Curriculum Rigour: Evidence, Debate & Assessment
Lesson 1 **The Reformation & The Break with Rome (1517–1547)** CAUSATION & MOTIVATION	• Explain how Martin Luther's 1517 protest shattered Catholic unity across Europe. • Analyse why the dynastic succession made an annulment an existential crisis for Henry VIII. • Evaluate how Thomas Cromwell used parliamentary statutes to establish Royal Supremacy. *Hinge Q: Why did printing the Bible in everyday German threaten the institutional power of Catholic priests?*	**PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS:** Source A: Lucas Cranach the Elder, Portrait of Martin Luther (1529); Source B: Hans Holbein the Younger, Whitehall Mural Portrait of King Henry VIII (c. 1537) **DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS:** Explain why King Henry VIII broke with Rome in the period 1527–1534. Evaluate which motive was decisive: his dynastic need for a male heir, financial greed for church wealth, or craving for absolute royal sovereignty. **CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT:** **[Evaluative Enquiry] Explain why King Henry VIII broke with Rome in the period 1527–1534. Evaluate which motive was decisive: his dynastic need for a male heir, financial greed for church...**
Lesson 2 **Elizabeth I & The Middle Way (1558–1588)** HISTORICAL SIGNIFICANCE & COMPROMISE	• Explain why England was religiously fractured in 1558 following Mary I's reign. • Analyse the key compromises of the 1559 Elizabethan Religious Settlement. • Evaluate how foreign plots and papal excommunication transformed English Catholics into suspected traitors. *Hinge Q: Why did Mary's persecution of Protestants harden resistance rather than restore Catholic loyalty?*	**PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS:** Source A: Antonis Mor, Portrait of Queen Mary I ("Bloody Mary") (1554); Source B: The Armada Portrait of Queen Elizabeth I (c. 1588); Source B: George Gower (attr.), The Armada Portrait of Queen Elizabeth I (c. 1588) **DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS:** Explain the importance of the Elizabethan Religious Settlement (1559) for religious stability in England. Evaluate whether the Via Media succeeded because it was a genuine religious compromise or because Elizabeth enforced strict legal obedience. **CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT:** **[Evaluative Enquiry] Explain the importance of the Elizabethan Religious Settlement (1559) for religious stability in England. Evaluate whether the Via Media succeeded because it was a ge...**
Lesson 3 **The Spanish Armada & Naval Warfare (1588)** CAUSATION & STRATEGIC EVALUATION	• Explain how Drake's 1587 raid on Cadiz undermined the Spanish invasion plan. • Analyse the tactical contrast between Spanish boarding tactics and English standoff broadsides. • Evaluate the decisive impact of the Calais fireships and Atlantic storms. *Hinge Q: Why did early modern navies depend so heavily on seasoned wooden barrels for survival at sea?*	**PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS:** Source A: Contemporary Chart of Drake's Raid on Cadiz (1587); Source B: Philip James de Loutherbourg, The Battle of Gravelines (1588); Source A: Contemporary Chart of Sir Francis Drake's Raid on Cadiz (1587) **DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS:** Write a narrative account analysing the key events of the Spanish Armada campaign in the summer of 1588. Explain why Philip II's invasion failed, evaluating English naval tactics and the role of severe weather. **CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT:** **[Evaluative Enquiry] Write a narrative account analysing the key events of the Spanish Armada campaign in the summer of 1588. Explain why Philip II's invasion failed, evaluating English n...**

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives & Enquiry	Curriculum Rigour: Evidence, Debate & Assessment
Lesson 4 **The Civil War, Regicide & The Bill of Rights (1642–1689)** 🎯 CAUSATION & CONSTITUTIONAL CHANGE	• Explain why Charles I's Personal Rule and Ship Money provoked constitutional outrage. • Analyse how the New Model Army defeated the King and radicalized politics. • Evaluate how the 1689 Bill of Rights permanently limited royal sovereignty. *Hinge Q: Why did John Hampden's refusal to pay 20 shillings in Ship Money turn into a national test case?*	📜 **PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS:** Source A: Anthony van Dyck, Portrait of King Charles I (1636); Source B: Contemporary Broadside of the Execution of Charles I (1649); Source B: Contemporary German Broadside of the Execution of Charles I (1649) ⚖️ **DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS:** Explain why Parliament put King Charles I on trial and executed him in January 1649. Evaluate whether the regicide was caused primarily by Charles I's refusal to accept constitutional limits, or the radicalization of the New Model Army. ✍️ **CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT:** **[Evaluative Enquiry] Explain why Parliament put King Charles I on trial and executed him in January 1649. Evaluate whether the regicide was caused primarily by Charles I's refusal to acce...**
Lesson 5 **Crown, Church, or Parliament? (1517–1689)** 🎯 SYNOPTIC EVALUATION & EXTENT OF CHANGE	• Analyse how Henry VIII inadvertently empowered Parliament during the Reformation. • Contrast Tudor partnership with Stuart absolutism. • Synthesize the synoptic extent of change between 1517 and 1689. *Hinge Q: Why could Henry VIII not simply declare himself Supreme Head by royal decree without Parliament?*	📜 **PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS:** Source A: The 1689 Bill of Rights (Original Statute Scroll); Source B: Prince William of Orange Landing at Brixham (5 November 1688); Source B: Contemporary Painting, Prince William of Orange Landing at Brixham (1688) ⚖️ **DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS:** "Between 1517 and 1689, the balance of power shifted completely from the Crown to Parliament." How far do you agree with this statement? Support your answer using evidence across the period (Henry VIII, Elizabeth I, the Civil War, and the 1689 Bill of Rights). ✍️ **CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT:** **[Evaluative Enquiry] "Between 1517 and 1689, the balance of power shifted completely from the Crown to Parliament." How far do you agree with this statement? Support your answer using evi...**

Unit Key Vocabulary: Reformation • Indulgence • Act of Supremacy • Tudor Rollercoaster • Middle Way • Excommunication • Armada • Divine Right of Kings • Ship Money • New Model Army • Regicide • Bill of Rights

The First British Empire (1600–1783)

Year 8 | How did trade, slavery, and rebellion shape the First British Empire?

🌀 **SPIRAL CURRICULUM THEMATIC STRANDS (VERTICAL DISCIPLINARY PROGRESSION)** CHRISTINE COUNSELL CURRICULAR THREADS

SOVEREIGNTY & POWER	TRADE & TECHNOLOGY	IDEOLOGY & CAUSATION	RESISTANCE & AGENCY
State institutions, governance, authority and constitutional development	Economic engines, technical innovations and overseas geopolitical interactions	Religious beliefs, philosophical movements and drivers of historical change	Popular protest, social struggle, rights development and civilian agency

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives & Enquiry	Curriculum Rigour: Evidence, Debate & Assessment
Lesson 1 **The East India Company & Mughal Bengal (1600–1757)** 🎯 CAUSATION & MOTIVE	• Explain why the East India Company was formed and how factories operated in Mughal India. • Analyse the causal factors that enabled Robert Clive to triumph at the Battle of Plassey. • Evaluate the constitutional and human consequences of the 1765 Treaty of Allahabad. *Hinge Q: Hinge Question: Why did the Mughal Emperor permit English merchants to build fortified factories along the coastline?*	📜 **PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS:** Source A: Nathaniel Dance, Portrait of Major-General Robert Clive (1773); Source B: Benjamin West, Shah Alam II Conveying the Grant of the Diwani to Lord Clive (1795) ⚖️ **DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS:** Evaluate the constitutional and human consequences of the 1765 Treaty of Allahabad. ✍️ **CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT:** **[Written Synthesis] Complete structured analytical enquiry response in pupil workbook.**

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives & Enquiry	Curriculum Rigour: Evidence, Debate & Assessment
Lesson 2 **The Transatlantic Slave Trade & The Middle Passage (1619–1807)** 🎯 SOURCE UTILITY & FORENSIC EVIDENCE	• Explain the three legs of the Triangular Trade and identify the goods exchanged on each leg. • Evaluate the physical conditions and human suffering endured during the Middle Passage. • Analyse how enslaved Africans resisted captivity, from shipboard insurrections to Equiano's writing. ***Hinge Q: Hinge Question: How did British manufacturing cities like Manchester and Birmingham directly profit from the slave trade even if they never saw a slave ship?***	📜 **PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS:** Source A: The Plymouth Committee, Stowage of the British Slave Ship Brookes (1788); Source B: Daniel Orme, Portrait of Olaudah Equiano / Gustavus Vassa (1789) ⚖️ **DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS:** Evaluate the physical conditions and human suffering endured during the Middle Passage. ✍️ **CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT:** **[Written Synthesis] Complete structured analytical enquiry response in pupil workbook.**
Lesson 3 **Plantation Reality, Queen Nanny & Maroon Resistance (1655–1740)** 🎯 HISTORICAL INTERPRETATIONS & SIGNIFICANCE	• Describe the organisation and physical brutality of the sugar plantation gang system. • Identify and categorise different methods of everyday enslaved resistance. • Analyse how Queen Nanny and the Maroons forced the British Crown into the 1739 Peace Treaty. ***Hinge Q: Hinge Question: Why was life expectancy on Caribbean sugar plantations significantly lower than on North American farms?***	📜 **PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS:** Source A: William Clark, Slaves Cutting the Sugar Cane in Antigua (1823); Source B: Memorial Bust of Queen Nanny of the Maroons, National Heroes Park ⚖️ **DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS:** Question 3(b) & 3(c): Contrasting Interpretations [8 marks • 10 mins] ✍️ **CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT:** **[Written Synthesis] Complete structured analytical enquiry response in pupil workbook.**
Lesson 4 **The Thirteen Colonies, The Proclamation of 1763 & The Boston Tea Party (1763–1773)** 🎯 CAUSAL SEQUENCING & NARRATIVE ACCOUNT	• Explain why the Seven Years' War created imperial debt and prompted new colonial taxation. • Analyse the ideological argument behind "No taxation without representation" during the Stamp Act crisis. • Deconstruct Paul Revere's Boston Massacre engraving as a piece of political propaganda. ***Hinge Q: Hinge Question: Was it reasonable for the British government to expect American colonists to pay toward their own military defence?***	📜 **PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS:** Source A: Paul Revere, The Bloody Massacre in King-Street (March 1770); Source B: Currier & Ives, The Boston Tea Party (1846 lithograph); Source B: Currier & Ives, The Boston Tea Party (1846 retrospective print) ⚖️ **DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS:** Core Disciplinary Concept: Historical Enquiry & Causal Argumentation ✍️ **CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT:** **[Written Synthesis] Complete structured analytical enquiry response in pupil workbook.**
Lesson 5 **The American Revolution, 1776 Declaration & The Black Loyalists (1775–1783)** 🎯 EVALUATIVE SYNTHESIS & HISTORICAL VERDICT	• Explain why armed conflict began at Lexington and Concord and how Washington took command. • Analyse the central moral paradox of the 1776 Declaration of Independence. • Synthesise the military reasons for British defeat and the historical significance of the Black Loyalists. ***Hinge Q: Hinge Question: Why did Lord Dunmore's offer of freedom to enslaved people cause more terror among American rebels than British cannons?***	📜 **PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS:** Source A: John Trumbull, Declaration of Independence (1819); Source B: Excerpt from Lord Dunmore's Proclamation, Williamsburg, Virginia (November 1775) ⚖️ **DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS:** Core Disciplinary Concept: Historical Enquiry & Causal Argumentation ✍️ **CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT:** **[Written Synthesis] Complete structured analytical enquiry response in pupil workbook.**

Unit Key Vocabulary: Charter • Mercantilism • Monopoly • Diwani • Transatlantic Trade • Middle Passage • Chattel Slavery • Maroon • Boycott • Sons of Liberty • Declaration • Black Loyalist